

# Psalms 15

*Who May Dwell With God*

Lord, who shall abide in thy tabernacle?

KJV · Standalone study handout

## 1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *LORD, who shall abide in thy tabernacle? who shall dwell in thy holy hill?*
- 2 *He that walketh uprightly, and worketh righteousness, and speaketh the truth in his heart.*
- 3 *He that backbiteth not with his tongue, nor doeth evil to his neighbour, nor taketh up a reproach against his neighbour.*
- 4 *In whose eyes a vile person is contemned; but he honoureth them that fear the LORD. He that sweareth to his own hurt, and changeth not.*
- 5 *He that putteth not out his money to usury, nor taketh reward against the innocent. He that doeth these things shall never be moved.*

## 2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 15 is an entrance liturgy: a question about who may approach and dwell with God, answered with a character sketch rather than a ritual checklist. David describes integrity in speech, dealings with neighbors, and financial ethics as the marks of one who may abide on God's "holy hill." Henry and later evangelical readers note that these qualities describe fruit that flows from grace, not a ladder of self-achieved merit, since only Christ perfectly fulfills this description.

## 3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

*The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.*

### Verse 1

The opening question sets the whole psalm's agenda: who may abide in God's tabernacle, who may dwell in His holy hill? Access to God's presence is the concern, not merely correct doctrine.

### Verse 2-3

The answer begins with integrity: walking uprightly, working righteousness, speaking truth in the heart. Negatively, no backbiting, no reproach of a neighbor, no slander of a friend—speech that builds up rather than tears down community.

### Verse 4-5

Further marks: despising what is vile even when connected to the wicked, honoring those who fear the Lord, keeping an oath even when it hurts, refusing usury against the poor, and refusing bribes against the innocent. The psalm closes with a promise: such a person "shall never be moved."

## 4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

### Meaning.

Nearness to God is inseparable from a life of integrity—truthful speech, faithful promises, and just dealing with others—that flows from, rather than earns, a settled relationship with Him.

### Application for life today.

Use this psalm as a diagnostic for daily integrity: is your speech about others building up or tearing down? Do you keep your word even when it costs you? Are your financial dealings marked by fairness rather than exploiting the vulnerable? Ask the Spirit to produce this character in you as fruit of grace, not as a performance to earn access to God, who has already opened the way through Christ.

## 5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

*Write your answers in the space below. There are no "right length" answers—honesty before God is the aim.*

1. Which of the qualities in verses 2–5 do you find easiest, and which most challenges you right now?

**2.** Is there a promise you have been tempted to break because “it hurts”—what would faithfulness look like there?

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**3.** How does verse 5’s promise of stability (“never be moved”) motivate pursuing integrity rather than merely avoiding punishment?

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Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Group / Church: \_\_\_\_\_

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).